places they place these priests about the country as spies and political intriguers. I do not recollect whether I told you any thing about these affairs when they occurred as I keep no copies of my letters and forget what I write, if they interest you please tell me and I will let you know something of them. I am glad I have now no more of this sort of work to do; it was a great deal of trouble and I gained nothing by it, besides it sometimes made a little, but very little, bad feeling between me and some of my Greek friends here. These men having all received French education, are as is natural prejudiced in favor of the French cause. It is difficult for a lawyer to plead before a judge when he knows that his Lordship has at the very same time a bribe of twenty five pounds in his pocket to give the verdict against him. This has been my case more than once. One thing which used to amuse me was that I could never make my clients, the missionaries understand that the Govt (Persian) don't care one curse about either them or the Roman Catholics: and often played off one party against the other, here, to endeavour to get bribes from both. They only succeeded with the French who *bled* once or twice pretty freely.

I often think that my connexion with the missionaries is a very odd one. They are partisans and very strict ones, but at the same time liberal, most of them have taken the temperance pledge and the rest scarcely ever touch wine. I, on the contrary like my grog and my song. But with all this they have a great respect for me, and give me about forty tomauns a year for being their agent here. The fact is, I believe they find me useful and therefore take little notice of what they consider my sins and backslidings. They have given me fifteen vol: of tracts which I have never read except "the Pilgrims Progress" and another. They are chiefly about abstract points of puritan doctrine, such as "conversion" "election" "Degrees of grace" etc. and one day I chanced to look through them to find something about "charity" and found nothing; this has given me a disgust for them and I have scarcely looked at them since. Men were no doubt created with different dispositions and qualities like the animals and I do not think I was intended for a puritan.

The Shah, thanks to the care of Dr Bell[99] has recovered from his dangerous attack of the gout. I don't wonder at the newspapers in Europe killing him; he was all but gone. The Prime Minister has been celebrating the Shah's recovery by ruining many of the men about the court, some of them those who had attended upon him most faithfully when speechless and insensible and not expected to live many hours. H: M: is between you and I little better than an ass. He thinks the prime minister a God incarnate and shuts his eyes to the confusion which now reigns in a great part of Persia.

[99] Physician attached to the British mission.

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